

Counseling Management System Professional Project Blueprint

Purpose: This blueprint serves as the master reference for planning, building, testing, deploying, and maintaining the Counseling Management System.

1. Project Overview

- Build a professional counseling platform for clients and administrators.
- Primary goals: online appointment booking, user management, content management, secure administration, and deployment.

2. Business Problem

- Manual booking is slow and error-prone.
- Clients need an easy way to discover services and request appointments.
- Administrators need a centralized dashboard.

3. Project Objectives

- Deliver a responsive web application.
- Learn HTML, CSS, JavaScript, Python, Django, SQL and deployment.
- Produce a portfolio-quality project.

4. Project Scope

- Frontend website
- Backend with Django
- Authentication
- Appointment booking
- Admin dashboard
- Email notifications
- Deployment

5. User Personas

- Visitor: explores services.
- Client: books appointments.

- Administrator: manages the platform.

6. User Journey

- Visit website
- Create account
- Book appointment
- Receive confirmation
- Attend session
- View history in dashboard

7. Functional Features

- Home, About, Services, Contact, FAQ
- Registration & Login
- Appointment booking
- Email confirmation
- Client dashboard
- Admin dashboard
- Blog/Articles

8. Non-Functional Requirements

- Responsive design
- Accessibility
- Performance
- Security
- Maintainability
- Scalability

9. Phase 1 – Frontend

- Recreate the approved UI with HTML/CSS/JS.
- Build reusable components.
- Responsive testing.

10. Phase 2 – Django

- Project setup
- Templates
- Static files
- Apps
- Routing

11. Phase 3 – Database & Core Features

- Models
- Authentication
- Appointment workflow
- Dashboards

12. Phase 4 – Advanced Features

- Email reminders
- Calendar
- Search
- Blog
- Notifications

13. Phase 5 – Testing & Deployment

- Functional testing
- Security testing
- Deployment
- Documentation

14. Frontend Architecture

- Pages
- Components
- CSS structure

- JavaScript modules

15. Backend Architecture

- Django apps
- Views
- Templates
- Models
- URLs
- Services

16. Database Design

- Users
- Appointments
- Counselors
- Services
- Testimonials
- Blog Posts
- Contact Messages

17. UI/UX Standards

- Consistent spacing
- Reusable components
- Accessible forms
- Responsive layouts

18. Security Plan

- Authentication
- Authorization
- Password hashing
- CSRF
- Secure uploads

- HTTPS

- Backups

19. Testing Plan

- Unit tests

- Integration tests

- Manual testing

- Cross-browser testing

20. Deployment Plan

- Virtual environment

- Production settings

- PostgreSQL

- Static files

- Domain

- SSL

21. Maintenance Plan

- Bug fixes

- Feature updates

- Database backups

- Monitoring

22. Future Roadmap

- Video counseling

- Payments

- Mobile app

- AI assistant

- SMS reminders

23. Weekly Learning Schedule

- Week 1-2: Frontend
- Week 3: Finish UI
- Week 4-5: Django
- Week 6-7: Database
- Week 8-9: Features
- Week 10: Testing
- Week 11: Deployment
- Week 12: Polish

24. Daily Development Checklist

- Review tasks
- Code
- Test
- Commit to Git
- Document progress

25. Milestones

- Frontend complete
- Django integrated
- Booking works
- Emails work
- Deployment complete

26. Progress Tracker

- Planning
- Frontend
- Backend
- Database
- Testing
- Deployment

- Completed

27. Recommended Folder Structure

- templates/
- static/css
- static/js
- static/images
- accounts
- appointments
- dashboard
- blog
- notifications

28. Git Workflow

- Initialize repository
- Commit after each feature
- Use descriptive commit messages
- Create releases

29. Success Criteria

- Responsive
- Secure
- Fully functional
- Documented
- Deployable

30. Final Notes

- Treat this document as the project's master blueprint (SRS-lite). Update it whenever requirements change.

Appendix: Recommended Development Order

- Finalize UI in HTML/CSS/JavaScript.

- Set up Django.
- Integrate templates.
- Design database models.
- Implement authentication.
- Implement appointment booking.
- Build dashboards.
- Add email notifications.
- Test thoroughly.
- Deploy and document.